

Practical response strategies when coworkers or managers take credit for your work — Action Checklist

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CONFIRM BEFORE YOU ACT

- ☐ **Confirm Before You Act, Item 1:** Answer the three assessment questions honestly using only facts—not interpretations—what exactly was said, what exactly was your contribution, and did intent appear to be present.
- ☐ **Confirm Before You Act, Item 2:** Complete the Credit Audit Worksheet in writing to separate what actually happened from what the situation means about your value as a professional.
- ☐ **Confirm Before You Act, Item 3:** Identify one piece of work you know for certain was yours with no disputed attribution to use as your emotional anchor when doubt starts creeping in.
- ☐ **Confirm Before You Act, Item 4:** Wait 24 hours before taking any action if you are uncertain whether theft actually occurred or if you are still emotionally charged from the incident.

DOCUMENT YOUR WORK

- ☐ **Document Your Work, Item 1:** Start a written record of each incident that includes the date, who was present, the exact words used, and what specific work was claimed as someone else's.
- ☐ **Document Your Work, Item 2:** Preserve copies of your original work by saving emails, files, and version history that prove you created or contributed to the work being stolen.
- ☐ **Document Your Work, Item 3:** Note all witnesses who observed your contribution in real time so you have corroboration available if you need to reference the incident later.
- ☐ **Document Your Work, Item 4:** Track patterns over weeks or months instead of treating incidents as isolated events so you can identify whether this is a systematic problem with specific people.

RESPOND AND PROTECT

- ☐ **Respond and Protect, Item 1:** Speak directly to the person in a private conversation first using factual language rather than an accusatory tone before escalating to anyone else.
 - ☐ **Respond and Protect, Item 2:** Make your contributions publicly visible to decision-makers by sharing your work early in meetings and naturally tagging your involvement when appropriate.
 - ☐ **Respond and Protect, Item 3:** Ask clarifying questions in group settings without assigning blame when credit is being misattributed so others notice the omission themselves.
 - ☐ **Respond and Protect, Item 4:** Request written acknowledgment of your contribution from stakeholders involved so there is a documented trail protecting your work going forward.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.